

The first, of course, is the SIM card PIN Code. You will normally be given a PIN code when you purchase your SIM card. Actually you will be given four sets of codes when you purchase the phone: PIN1, PIN2, PUK1, and PUK2.

- PIN1 activates your phone when you first switch it on.
- PIN2 is used when you need to access some advanced functions.
- PUK1 is used if you forget or enter the wrong PIN1 code. If you enter the wrong PIN1 code three times, the SIM card locks and you will need to enter the PUK1 code to unlock it and reset your PIN1 code. If you lose your PUK number, there is no other recourse than to get a new SIM card from your cell phone service provider.
- PUK2 is similar to PUK1, and is used for PIN2.

Along with the above, you should also consider locking your phone with a phone-specific security code. This will effectively stop anyone from accessing the phone if they do not know the code. Even if they switch off the phone, remove the SIM and replace it with another, they will still be unable to access the phone without the security code.

One other measure is to use a keyguard code for locking your phone. Most cell phones support automatic locking of the keypad after a period of inactivity. This prevents dialling if the keys get inadvertently depressed when in your pocket. You will have to press a combination of keys (Nokia: Menu *) to unlock the phone or to manually lock it. You can set your phone to require a code when you unlock your keypad. Also make it a habit to manually lock your phone immediately after a call. Sometimes, the keyguard will fail to kick in as some key has already been accidentally depressed before the keyguard activation time-out.